

Spelling tips

If you can't find the word you are looking up, you may have spelled it incorrectly. Here are some spelling tips.

Split long words

To make it easier to look up or spell long words, split them into **syllables**. A syllable is one short sound in a word. Then work out the order of the letters in each syllable.

For example:

Elephant has three syllables. It seems easier to put the first syllable, "el," into alphabetical order than "elephant."



Syllables...

el-e-phant

1

2

3

How many syllables do these words have? (Answers on page 256)

1. happy
2. sad
3. expensive
4. impossible
5. enthusiastically

Confusing spellings

Not all words are spelled the way they sound. This can make it hard to look things up. Read these common problem words to help you spell difficult words.

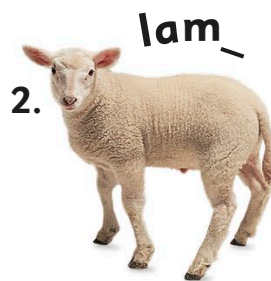
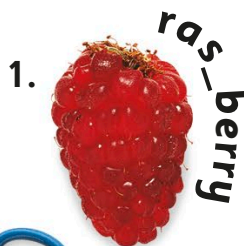
Ph pronounced like an f

alphabet, telephone, pharaoh, elephant, photograph

Silent letters

climb, comb, doubt, ghost, gnaw, hour, knee, knife, sword, whole, wrap, wreck, wriggle, write

Do you know what the missing silent letters are in these words? (Answers on page 256)



6. supercalifragilisticexpialidocious!